

- GIF (Graphics Interchange Format)
- BMP (Bitmap)
- PSD (Photoshop Document)

When you choose the file format you want to work with, to beginners it may seem like an inconsequential decision. However, it is far from that. Depending on the level of the quality and the amount of post processing you intend to do, choosing the right file format becomes a critical part of the journey.

JPEG

This is easily the most popularly known of all file formats and also what most digital cameras will provide as the default output. JPEG files get compressed quickly while in the camera. So it is important to remember that this comes with a loss of detail as well as quality.

Ideal Usage:

- For personal use, social media, albums for storage, small prints
- Least amount of post production using software like Photoshop or Lightroom
- To share images via email (when images are not intended for large prints)

Pros:

- More files can be saved on the memory card
- Quicker transfer time for files given their size

Cons:

- Lesser quality than other formats given image compression
- Lowered opportunity for manipulation in post processing stage

TIFF

Like JPEG which is the most popularly known by the masses, TIFF is the most commonly known and accepted industry-standard file format. Formats like these are usually uncompressed, which means that there lies a higher opportunity for manipulation in post processing.

Pros:

- Can be used to manipulate photos in photo editing software
- Can be used for extremely large prints with highest quality

Cons:

- Big file sizes = More storage needed
- High loading and transfer times given the file sizes